

BibInVs MN 51

Colossians

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 51*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Colossians

Colossians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, have been sent on special assignment by Christ as part of God's master plan. Together with my friend Timothy,
- 1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and Timothy our brother,
- 2 I greet the Christians and stalwart followers of Christ who live in Colosse. May everything good from God our Father be yours!
- 2 To the holy and faithful brothers in Christ at Colosse: Grace and peace to you from God our Father.
- 3 Our prayers for you are always spilling over into thanksgivings. We can't quit thanking God our Father and Jesus our Messiah for you!
- 3 We always thank God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, when we pray for you,
- 4 We keep getting reports on your steady faith in Christ, our Jesus, and the love you continuously extend to all Christians.
- 4 because we have heard of your faith in Christ Jesus and of the love you have for all the saints--
- 5 The lines of purpose in your lives never grow slack, tightly tied as they are to your future in heaven, kept taut by hope. The Message is as true among you today as when you first heard it. It doesn't diminish or weaken over time.
- 5 the faith and love that spring from the hope that is stored up for you in heaven and that you have already heard about in the word of truth, the gospel
- 6 It's the same all over the world. The Message bears fruit and gets larger and stronger, just as it has in you. From the very first day you heard and recognized the truth of what God is doing, you've been hungry for more.

- 6 that has come to you. All over the world this gospel is bearing fruit and growing, just as it has been doing among you since the day you heard it and understood God's grace in all its truth.
- 7 It's as vigorous in you now as when you learned it from our friend and close associate Epaphras. He is one reliable worker for Christ! I could always depend on him.
- 7 You learned it from Epaphras, our dear fellow servant, who is a faithful minister of Christ on our behalf,
- 8 He's the one who told us how thoroughly love had been worked into your lives by the Spirit.
- 8 and who also told us of your love in the Spirit.
- 9 Be assured that from the first day we heard of you, we haven't stopped praying for you, asking God to give you wise minds and spirits attuned to his will, and so acquire a thorough understanding of the ways in which God works.
- 9 For this reason, since the day we heard about you, we have not stopped praying for you and asking God to fill you with the knowledge of his will through all spiritual wisdom and understanding.
- 10 We pray that you'll live well for the Master, making him proud of you as you work hard in his orchard. As you learn more and more how God works, you will learn how to do your work.
- 10 And we pray this in order that you may live a life worthy of the Lord and may please him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God,
- 11 We pray that you'll have the strength to stick it out over the long haul--not the grim strength of gritting your teeth but the glory-strength God gives. It is strength that endures the unendurable and spills over into joy,
- 11 being strengthened with all power according to his glorious might so that you may have great endurance and patience, and joyfully
- 12 thanking the Father who makes us strong enough to take part in everything bright and beautiful that he has for us.
- 12 giving thanks to the Father, who has qualified you to share in the inheritance of the saints in the kingdom of light.
- 13 God rescued us from dead-end alleys and dark dungeons. He's set us up in the kingdom of the Son he loves so much,

- 13 For he has rescued us from the dominion of darkness and brought us into the kingdom of the Son he loves,
- 14 the Son who got us out of the pit we were in, got rid of the sins we were doomed to keep repeating.
- 14 in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins.
- 15 We look at this Son and see the God who cannot be seen. We look at this Son and see God's original purpose in everything created.
- 15 He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation.
- 16 For everything, absolutely everything, above and below, visible and invisible, rank after rank after rank of angels--everything got started in him and finds its purpose in him.
- 16 For by him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or powers or rulers or authorities; all things were created by him and for him.
- 17 He was there before any of it came into existence and holds it all together right up to this moment.
- 17 He is before all things, and in him all things hold together.
- 18 And when it comes to the church, he organizes and holds it together, like a head does a body. He was supreme in the beginning and--leading the resurrection parade--he is supreme in the end. From beginning to end he's there, towering far above everything, everyone.
- 18 And he is the head of the body, the church; he is the beginning and the firstborn from among the dead, so that in everything he might have the supremacy.
- 19 So spacious is he, so roomy, that everything of God finds its proper place in him without crowding.
- 19 For God was pleased to have all his fullness dwell in him,
- 20 Not only that, but all the broken and dislocated pieces of the universe--people and things, animals and atoms--get properly fixed and fit together in vibrant harmonies, all because of his death, his blood that poured down from the Cross.
- 20 and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether things on earth or things in heaven, by making peace through his blood, shed on the cross.
- 21 You yourselves are a case study of what he does. At one time you all had your backs turned to God, thinking rebellious thoughts of him,

giving him trouble every chance you got.

21 Once you were alienated from God and were enemies in your minds because of your evil behavior.

22 But now, by giving himself completely at the Cross, actually dying for you, Christ brought you over to God's side and put your lives together, whole and holy in his presence.

22 But now he has reconciled you by Christ's physical body through death to present you holy in his sight, without blemish and free from accusation--

23 You don't walk away from a gift like that! You stay grounded and steady in that bond of trust, constantly tuned in to the Message, careful not to be distracted or diverted. There is no other Message--just this one. Every creature under heaven gets this same Message. I, Paul, am a messenger of this Message.

23 if you continue in your faith, established and firm, not moved from the hope held out in the gospel. This is the gospel that you heard and that has been proclaimed to every creature under heaven, and of which I, Paul, have become a servant.

24 I want you to know how glad I am that it's me sitting here in this jail and not you. There's a lot of suffering to be entered into in this world--the kind of suffering Christ takes on. I welcome the chance to take my share in the church's part of that suffering.

24 Now I rejoice in what was suffered for you, and I fill up in my flesh what is still lacking in regard to Christ's afflictions, for the sake of his body, which is the church.

25 When I became a servant in this church, I experienced this suffering as a sheer gift, God's way of helping me serve you, laying out the whole truth.

25 I have become its servant by the commission God gave me to present to you the word of God in its fullness--

26 This mystery has been kept in the dark for a long time, but now it's out in the open.

26 the mystery that has been kept hidden for ages and generations, but is now disclosed to the saints.

27 God wanted everyone, not just Jews, to know this rich and glorious secret inside and out, regardless of their background, regardless of their

religious standing. The mystery in a nutshell is just this: Christ is in you, therefore you can look forward to sharing in God's glory. It's that simple. That is the substance of our Message.

- 27 To them God has chosen to make known among the Gentiles the glorious riches of this mystery, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory.
- 28 We preach Christ, warning people not to add to the Message. We teach in a spirit of profound common sense so that we can bring each person to maturity. To be mature is to be basic. Christ! No more, no less.
- 28 We proclaim him, admonishing and teaching everyone with all wisdom, so that we may present everyone perfect in Christ.
- 29 That's what I'm working so hard at day after day, year after year, doing my best with the energy God so generously gives me.
- 29 To this end I labor, struggling with all his energy, which so powerfully works in me.

Colossians 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 I want you to realize that I continue to work as hard as I know how for you, and also for the Christians over at Laodicea. Not many of you have met me face-to-face, but that doesn't make any difference. Know that I'm on your side, right alongside you. You're not in this alone.
- 1 I want you to know how much I am struggling for you and for those at Laodicea, and for all who have not met me personally.
- 2 I want you woven into a tapestry of love, in touch with everything there is to know of God. Then you will have minds confident and at rest, focused on Christ, God's great mystery.
- 2 My purpose is that they may be encouraged in heart and united in love, so that they may have the full riches of complete understanding, in order that they may know the mystery of God, namely, Christ,
- 3 All the richest treasures of wisdom and knowledge are embedded in that mystery and nowhere else. And we've been shown the mystery!
- 3 in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.
- 4 I'm telling you this because I don't want anyone leading you off on some wild-goose chase, after other so-called mysteries, or "the Secret."

- 4 I tell you this so that no one may deceive you by fine-sounding arguments.
- 5 I'm a long way off, true, and you may never lay eyes on me, but believe me, I'm on your side, right beside you. I am delighted to hear of the careful and orderly ways you conduct your affairs, and impressed with the solid substance of your faith in Christ.
- 5 For though I am absent from you in body, I am present with you in spirit and delight to see how orderly you are and how firm your faith in Christ is.
- 6 My counsel for you is simple and straightforward: Just go ahead with what you've been given. You received Christ Jesus, the Master; now live him.
- 6 So then, just as you received Christ Jesus as Lord, continue to live in him,
- 7 You're deeply rooted in him. You're well constructed upon him. You know your way around the faith. Now do what you've been taught. School's out; quit studying the subject and start living it! And let your living spill over into thanksgiving.
- 7 rooted and built up in him, strengthened in the faith as you were taught, and overflowing with thankfulness.
- 8 Watch out for people who try to dazzle you with big words and intellectual double-talk. They want to drag you off into endless arguments that never amount to anything. They spread their ideas through the empty traditions of human beings and the empty superstitions of spirit beings. But that's not the way of Christ.
- 8 See to it that no one takes you captive through hollow and deceptive philosophy, which depends on human tradition and the basic principles of this world rather than on Christ.
- 9 Everything of God gets expressed in him, so you can see and hear him clearly. You don't need a telescope, a microscope, or a horoscope to realize the fullness of Christ, and the emptiness of the universe without him.
- 9 For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity lives in bodily form,
- 10 When you come to him, that fullness comes together for you, too. His power extends over everything.

- 10 and you have been given fullness in Christ, who is the head over every power and authority.
- 11 Entering into this fullness is not something you figure out or achieve. It's not a matter of being circumcised or keeping a long list of laws. No, you're already in--insiders--not through some secretive initiation rite but rather through what Christ has already gone through for you, destroying the power of sin.
- 11 In him you were also circumcised, in the putting off of the sinful nature, not with a circumcision done by the hands of men but with the circumcision done by Christ,
- 12 If it's an initiation ritual you're after, you've already been through it by submitting to baptism. Going under the water was a burial of your old life; coming up out of it was a resurrection, God raising you from the dead as he did Christ.
- 12 having been buried with him in baptism and raised with him through your faith in the power of God, who raised him from the dead.
- 13 When you were stuck in your old sin-dead life, you were incapable of responding to God. God brought you alive--right along with Christ! Think of it! All sins forgiven,
- 13 When you were dead in your sins and in the uncircumcision of your sinful nature, God made you alive with Christ. He forgave us all our sins,
- 14 the slate wiped clean, that old arrest warrant canceled and nailed to Christ's Cross.
- 14 having canceled the written code, with its regulations, that was against us and that stood opposed to us; he took it away, nailing it to the cross.
- 15 He stripped all the spiritual tyrants in the universe of their sham authority at the Cross and marched them naked through the streets.
- 15 And having disarmed the powers and authorities, he made a public spectacle of them, triumphing over them by the cross.
- 16 So don't put up with anyone pressuring you in details of diet, worship services, or holy days.
- 16 Therefore do not let anyone judge you by what you eat or drink, or with regard to a religious festival, a New Moon celebration or a Sabbath day.
- 17 All those things are mere shadows cast before what was to come; the substance is Christ.

- 17 These are a shadow of the things that were to come; the reality, however, is found in Christ.
- 18 Don't tolerate people who try to run your life, ordering you to bow and scrape, insisting that you join their obsession with angels and that you seek out visions. They're a lot of hot air, that's all they are.
- 18 Do not let anyone who delights in false humility and the worship of angels disqualify you for the prize. Such a person goes into great detail about what he has seen, and his unspiritual mind puffs him up with idle notions.
- 19 They're completely out of touch with the source of life, Christ, who puts us together in one piece, whose very breath and blood flow through us. He is the Head and we are the body. We can grow up healthy in God only as he nourishes us.
- 19 He has lost connection with the Head, from whom the whole body, supported and held together by its ligaments and sinews, grows as God causes it to grow.
- 20 So, then, if with Christ you've put all that pretentious and infantile religion behind you, why do you let yourselves be bullied by it?
- 20 Since you died with Christ to the basic principles of this world, why, as though you still belonged to it, do you submit to its rules:
- 21 "Don't touch this! Don't taste that! Don't go near this!"
- 21 Do not handle! Do not taste! Do not touch!?
- 22 Do you think things that are here today and gone tomorrow are worth that kind of attention?
- 22 These are all destined to perish with use, because they are based on human commands and teachings.
- 23 Such things sound impressive if said in a deep enough voice. They even give the illusion of being pious and humble and ascetic. But they're just another way of showing off, making yourselves look important.
- 23 Such regulations indeed have an appearance of wisdom, with their self-imposed worship, their false humility and their harsh treatment of the body, but they lack any value in restraining sensual indulgence.

Colossians 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 So if you're serious about living this new resurrection life with Christ, act like it. Pursue the things over which Christ presides.
- 1 Since, then, you have been raised with Christ, set your hearts on things above, where Christ is seated at the right hand of God.
- 2 Don't shuffle along, eyes to the ground, absorbed with the things right in front of you. Look up, and be alert to what is going on around Christ--that's where the action is. See things from his perspective.
- 2 Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things.
- 3 Your old life is dead. Your new life, which is your real life--even though invisible to spectators--is with Christ in God. He is your life.
- 3 For you died, and your life is now hidden with Christ in God.
- 4 When Christ (your real life, remember) shows up again on this earth, you'll show up, too--the real you, the glorious you. Meanwhile, be content with obscurity, like Christ.
- 4 When Christ, who is your life, appears, then you also will appear with him in glory.
- 5 And that means killing off everything connected with that way of death: sexual promiscuity, impurity, lust, doing whatever you feel like whenever you feel like it, and grabbing whatever attracts your fancy. That's a life shaped by things and feelings instead of by God.
- 5 Put to death, therefore, whatever belongs to your earthly nature: sexual immorality, impurity, lust, evil desires and greed, which is idolatry.
- 6 It's because of this kind of thing that God is about to explode in anger.
- 6 Because of these, the wrath of God is coming.
- 7 It wasn't long ago that you were doing all that stuff and not knowing any better.
- 7 You used to walk in these ways, in the life you once lived.
- 8 But you know better now, so make sure it's all gone for good: bad temper, irritability, meanness, profanity, dirty talk.
- 8 But now you must rid yourselves of all such things as these: anger, rage, malice, slander, and filthy language from your lips.
- 9 Don't lie to one another. You're done with that old life. It's like a filthy set of ill-fitting clothes you've stripped off and put in the fire.
- 9 Do not lie to each other, since you have taken off your old self with its practices

- 10 Now you're dressed in a new wardrobe. Every item of your new way of life is custom-made by the Creator, with his label on it. All the old fashions are now obsolete.
- 10 and have put on the new self, which is being renewed in knowledge in the image of its Creator.
- 11 Words like Jewish and non-Jewish, religious and irreligious, insider and outsider, uncivilized and uncouth, slave and free, mean nothing. From now on everyone is defined by Christ, everyone is included in Christ.
- 11 Here there is no Greek or Jew, circumcised or uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave or free, but Christ is all, and is in all.
- 12 So, chosen by God for this new life of love, dress in the wardrobe God picked out for you: compassion, kindness, humility, quiet strength, discipline.
- 12 Therefore, as God's chosen people, holy and dearly loved, clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness and patience.
- 13 Be even-tempered, content with second place, quick to forgive an offense. Forgive as quickly and completely as the Master forgave you.
- 13 Bear with each other and forgive whatever grievances you may have against one another. Forgive as the Lord forgave you.
- 14 And regardless of what else you put on, wear love. It's your basic, all-purpose garment. Never be without it.
- 14 And over all these virtues put on love, which binds them all together in perfect unity.
- 15 Let the peace of Christ keep you in tune with each other, in step with each other. None of this going off and doing your own thing. And cultivate thankfulness.
- 15 Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, since as members of one body you were called to peace. And be thankful.
- 16 Let the Word of Christ--the Message--have the run of the house. Give it plenty of room in your lives. Instruct and direct one another using good common sense. And sing, sing your hearts out to God!
- 16 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom, and as you sing psalms, hymns and spiritual songs with gratitude in your hearts to God.
- 17 Let every detail in your lives--words, actions, whatever--be done in the name of the Master, Jesus, thanking God the Father every step of the

- way.
- 17 And whatever you do, whether in word or deed, do it all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through him.
- 18 Wives, understand and support your husbands by submitting to them in ways that honor the Master.
- 18 Wives, submit to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord.
- 19 Husbands, go all out in love for your wives. Don't take advantage of them.
- 19 Husbands, love your wives and do not be harsh with them.
- 20 Children, do what your parents tell you. This delights the Master no end.
- 20 Children, obey your parents in everything, for this pleases the Lord.
- 21 Parents, don't come down too hard on your children or you'll crush their spirits.
- 21 Fathers, do not embitter your children, or they will become discouraged.
- 22 Servants, do what you're told by your earthly masters. And don't just do the minimum that will get you by. Do your best.
- 22 Slaves, obey your earthly masters in everything; and do it, not only when their eye is on you and to win their favor, but with sincerity of heart and reverence for the Lord.
- 23 Work from the heart for your real Master, for God,
- 23 Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for men,
- 24 confident that you'll get paid in full when you come into your inheritance. Keep in mind always that the ultimate Master you're serving is Christ.
- 24 since you know that you will receive an inheritance from the Lord as a reward. It is the Lord Christ you are serving.
- 25 The sullen servant who does shoddy work will be held responsible. Being Christian doesn't cover up bad work.
- 25 Anyone who does wrong will be repaid for his wrong, and there is no favoritism.

Colossians 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 And masters, treat your servants considerately. Be fair with them. Don't forget for a minute that you, too, serve a Master--God in heaven.
- 1 Masters, provide your slaves with what is right and fair, because you know that you also have a Master in heaven.
- 2 Pray diligently. Stay alert, with your eyes wide open in gratitude.
- 2 Devote yourselves to prayer, being watchful and thankful.
- 3 Don't forget to pray for us, that God will open doors for telling the mystery of Christ, even while I'm locked up in this jail.
- 3 And pray for us, too, that God may open a door for our message, so that we may proclaim the mystery of Christ, for which I am in chains.
- 4 Pray that every time I open my mouth I'll be able to make Christ plain as day to them.
- 4 Pray that I may proclaim it clearly, as I should.
- 5 Use your heads as you live and work among outsiders. Don't miss a trick. Make the most of every opportunity.
- 5 Be wise in the way you act toward outsiders; make the most of every opportunity.
- 6 Be gracious in your speech. The goal is to bring out the best in others in a conversation, not put them down, not cut them out.
- 6 Let your conversation be always full of grace, seasoned with salt, so that you may know how to answer everyone.
- 7 My good friend Tychicus will tell you all about me. He's a trusted minister and companion in the service of the Master.
- 7 Tychicus will tell you all the news about me. He is a dear brother, a faithful minister and fellow servant in the Lord.
- 8 I've sent him to you so that you would know how things are with us, and so he could encourage you in your faith.
- 8 I am sending him to you for the express purpose that you may know about our circumstances and that he may encourage your hearts.
- 9 And I've sent Onesimus with him. Onesimus is one of you, and has become such a trusted and dear brother! Together they'll bring you up-to-date on everything that has been going on here.
- 9 He is coming with Onesimus, our faithful and dear brother, who is one of you. They will tell you everything that is happening here.

- 10 Aristarchus, who is in jail here with me, sends greetings; also Mark, cousin of Barnabas (you received a letter regarding him; if he shows up, welcome him);
- 10 My fellow prisoner Aristarchus sends you his greetings, as does Mark, the cousin of Barnabas. (You have received instructions about him; if he comes to you, welcome him.)
- 11 and also Jesus, the one they call Justus. These are the only ones left from the old crowd who have stuck with me in working for God's kingdom. Don't think they haven't been a big help!
- 11 Jesus, who is called Justus, also sends greetings. These are the only Jews among my fellow workers for the kingdom of God, and they have proved a comfort to me.
- 12 Epaphras, who is one of you, says hello. What a trooper he has been! He's been tireless in his prayers for you, praying that you'll stand firm, mature and confident in everything God wants you to do.
- 12 Epaphras, who is one of you and a servant of Christ Jesus, sends greetings. He is always wrestling in prayer for you, that you may stand firm in all the will of God, mature and fully assured.
- 13 I've watched him closely, and can report on how hard he has worked for you and for those in Laodicea and Hierapolis.
- 13 I vouch for him that he is working hard for you and for those at Laodicea and Hierapolis.
- 14 Luke, good friend and physician, and Demas both send greetings.
- 14 Our dear friend Luke, the doctor, and Demas send greetings.
- 15 Say hello to our friends in Laodicea; also to Nympha and the church that meets in her house.
- 15 Give my greetings to the brothers at Laodicea, and to Nympha and the church in her house.
- 16 After this letter has been read to you, make sure it gets read also in Laodicea. And get the letter that went to Laodicea and have it read to you.
- 16 After this letter has been read to you, see that it is also read in the church of the Laodiceans and that you in turn read the letter from Laodicea.
- 17 And, oh, yes, tell Archippus, "Do your best in the job you received from the Master. Do your very best."

- 17 Tell Archippus: "See to it that you complete the work you have received in the Lord."
- 18 I'm signing off in my own handwriting--Paul. Remember to pray for me in this jail. Grace be with you.
- 18 I, Paul, write this greeting in my own hand. Remember my chains. Grace be with you.